

RISHI ATHANIKAR

rishi@rishiathanikar.com
linkedin.com/in/rishiathanikar

(513) 388-1735
www.rishiathanikar.com

SUMMARY

Product leader with 10+ years delivering B2B SaaS, consumer, and AI-enabled platforms in regulated fintech, HRTech, and insurance operations. Expertise in ML-powered automation, risk scoring systems, payroll and banking infrastructure, and end-to-end product lifecycle management. Currently leading automated underwriting and risk diversification at Justworks. Proven track record of coaching product analysts, 0→1 product development and scaling mature products in complex, multi-stakeholder environments.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager
Justworks

05/2023 - present
New York, NY

- **Leading ML-powered underwriting model** for automated customer risk assessment and entity assignment, achieving 92% automated accuracy with human-in-loop design for edge cases, enabling risk-based pricing and reducing manual underwriting workload by 85%
- **Architected risk diversification strategy** across multiple regulated entities, integrating with Persona for KYB identity verification and business validation, and implementing automated assignment rules that protect unemployment insurance rate exposure and increased **risk-adjusted margins by 8%** across customer portfolio
- **Shipped automated compliance system** that retrieves structured data and auto-generates regulatory responses across **50 state jurisdictions**, achieving **>99% compliance rate** and reducing **operational overhead by 90%**
- **Redesigned financial service infrastructure** enabling accurate tax rate calculation, risk-based premium pricing, and automated compliance workflows, **unlocking \$5M in new revenue**
- **Automated NetSuite GL routing** (chart-of-accounts mapping) to separate SUI tax remittance from premium revenue, eliminating manual splits/reconciliations and **saving Finance 20 hours per quarter**
- **Championing AI adoption** through evaluation of new AI tools, hands-on prototyping with Claude Code/Cursor/no-code tools for testing concepts, mentoring and training fellow PMs on AI-assisted coding and SQL queries, and launching justworks.com/llms.txt to improve LLM content discoverability

Lead Product Manager
Stash Financial

07/2021 - 05/2023
New York, NY

- **Owned end-to-end migration of 92% of active accounts** from legacy BaaS provider to proprietary banking platform, coordinating across engineering, compliance, and operations with **zero service disruption**
- **Shipped Reg E-compliant in-app transactional dispute resolution workflow** and ops case integration, reducing dispute-related CX calls by **60%** and improving resolution time from **14 days to 3 days**
- **Managed third-party vendor relationship to launch optimized Direct Deposit solution** that increased monthly platform deposits by **7%** and reduced feature-related CX contacts by **95%**
- **Redesigned new bank account onboarding** to reduce friction in funding source linking and first money movement experience, increasing conversion by **14%** and average first deposit by **150% (\$43)**

Senior Product Manager, Retail & Digital Experience

Casper Sleep, Inc.

10/2019 - 07/2021

New York, NY

- **Launched custom Point-of-Sale** with Adyen for payment processing to **72 stores**, achieving successful adoption by **450+ retail employees in 1 week**
- **Launched POS integration with Affirm for financing**, delivering **\$4M in incremental retail revenue** for 2020
- **Led 0→1 product development** for connected devices (IoT) offering, managing hardware, firmware, and mobile app workstreams through successful beta prototypes, enabling a net new revenue stream

Product Manager, E-commerce and Mobile

Peet's Coffee & Tea

07/2017 - 09/2019

San Francisco, CA

- **Delivered iOS and Android loyalty apps from 0→1**, reaching **300K monthly active users** and **\$20M in mobile payment volume** in first 3 months, managing design, engineering, and payment integration across platforms
- **Launched peets.com redesign**, improving purchase funnel conversion by **12%** and monthly subscription sign-ups by **10%**, exceeding annual revenue target by **\$800K**
- **Led enterprise Identity Management platform implementation**, successfully migrating 1.5M user accounts for frictionless login experience

Technical Product Analyst

Wunderman Thompson

07/2013 - 07/2017

Seattle, WA

Technical Cofounder

Beander

05/2014 - 12/2016

Seattle, WA

Two-sided marketplace connecting 3 major US-based green coffee importers with 100+ small-batch roasters. Bootstrapped to profitability and successful exit in 2016.

Associate Product Analyst

Wunderman Thompson

07/2011 - 06/2013

Seattle, WA

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Product Strategy and Lifecycle Management:** End-to-end ownership from market analysis and 0→1, through launch, optimization, and scale
- **Regulated Environment Expertise:** Fintech compliance, insurance operations, multi-state regulatory frameworks, automated compliance systems
- **AI/ML Platform Development:** ML-powered automation, predictive modeling, human-in-loop workflows, AI adoption strategy
- **Data-Driven Decision Making:** SQL proficiency, A/B testing, funnel analysis, business intelligence, predictive analytics, Looker, Amplitude, Mixpanel, and Tableau
- **Enterprise SaaS Delivery:** Platform architecture, API design, system integration, third-party vendor management
- **Stakeholder and Client Management:** Cross-functional collaboration with engineering, operations, compliance, risk, finance, and executive leadership

EDUCATION

- **Masters, Information Systems** - University of Cincinnati, College of Business (2009 - 2011)
- **Bachelor's, Computer Science** - University of Mumbai (2005 - 2009)